PAPERBOY

WEDNESDAY, NOVEMBER 11, 2026

October inflation came in hot in a release that cannot say how hot year-on-year, hours after a Fed governor had publicly set 0.3% as his tripwire for a half-point December hike.

AI

Anthropic's filing: $70 to $78 a share, and $900bn of committed compute

WHAT HAPPENED

Amendment No. 2 to Anthropic's Form S-1, filed Tuesday under registration 333-299633, sets a price range of **$70 to $78** a share on 825,000,000 Class A shares, plus a 123,750,000-share underwriters' option. It lists on Nasdaq as ANT. Q3 revenue was **$17.0bn, up 1,127%** year-on-year. The number to hold on to sits further down: **about $900.9bn** of aggregate committed spending, substantially all compute and infrastructure, roughly $451.6bn of it falling before the end of 2030. Net proceeds come to about $84.6bn at the midpoint, $93.7bn with the option exercised, both including a separate $26bn private placement (filing).

WHAT IT MEANS

Nine hundred billion of obligations against seventeen billion of quarterly revenue is the AI-capex argument compressed into one document. The range sits well below the $1.5-2tn investors had discussed. The widely quoted $1.3tn valuation and the 18 November pricing date are in the coverage, not the filing. (Anthropic makes the model that writes this brief.)

WATCH NEXT

Pricing, reported for 18 November with trading the next day.

TSMC's board authorises up to $1bn into the two labs it manufactures for

WHAT HAPPENED

At Tuesday's board meeting TSMC authorised **up to $500m** in Anthropic, to be bought at the IPO price, and **up to $500m** in OpenAI in preferred stock, alongside capital appropriations of about **$40.9bn** (MarketScreener, TechNode). Two labels matter. "Up to" caps an authorisation; nothing is closed, and the Anthropic leg depends on an IPO price that does not yet exist. And a board passes capital appropriations, which authorise spending across periods -- not an annual capex budget, which is how one wire headlined it. We did not reach the resolution itself.

WHAT IT MEANS

Nvidia and AMD taking stakes in their own customers was already a circular-financing story. The foundry doing it is new, and it puts TSMC on both sides of its own order book. The $40.9bn is the bigger number and got the smaller headline.

WATCH NEXT

TSMC's own board release, and whether the Anthropic tranche converts at pricing.

Eight governments and four labs sign up to shutdown mechanisms, with no deadlines and no sanctions

WHAT HAPPENED

The Paris Call for AI Safety and Security was adopted at the Elysee on **9 November** -- a day outside our window, but it only reached coverage Tuesday. Eight governments signed, alongside OpenAI, Anthropic, Microsoft and Mistral, with Yoshua Bengio and US Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent present. Signatories commit to shared evaluation procedures, publishing non-sensitive test results in a standard format, risk-proportionate independent audits, and **shutdown mechanisms for models under their control**. Germany did not sign. The text is a political self-commitment that, as one account puts it, "sets neither deadlines nor sanctions" (elysee.fr).

WHAT IT MEANS

The first time frontier labs have put a shutdown commitment into a signed international text. Unenforceable -- but unenforceable commitments are what later regulation gets drafted against. Germany's absence is the awkward part: the EU's largest economy declining to sign a European declaration.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the signatory list grows, and what “non-sensitive” turns out to exclude.

SEMICONDUCTORS

Two negative checks, so nobody chases them: the Commerce Department's export-control page has published nothing since 2 October, and EDGAR lists no Nvidia filing since 26 August.

Nvidia's board hires an outside prosecutor, and the chip numbers get bigger

WHAT HAPPENED

Nvidia's newsroom carried a one-sentence statement Tuesday: the independent directors have retained **Joon H. Kim**, a former acting US Attorney for the Southern District of New York, and **Wachtell, Lipton, Rosen & Katz**, "to conduct a thorough and independent investigation". It names neither Jensen Huang nor a scope. What it does is route the inquiry around lead independent director Stephen Neal, whom people familiar had told the Financial Times would probably run it: Neal led Cooley from 2001 to 2008, is still its senior counsel, and Cooley has been Nvidia's principal outside counsel since 1993. Separately, The Information reported, citing two people who know her, that Huang's relationship with Alice Huang helped move **at least $7.5bn** of chips -- some 240,000 H100, H200 and A100-class parts -- to buyers in China; Reuters said it could not verify it. Senator Kevin Cramer, a senior Republican on Senate Banking, told Politico: "I just think he's got to go." The shares fell **5.47%**, and are down about 9.5% since the affair became public.

WHAT IT MEANS

The Cooley conflict is why the hire is the story: a board paying Wachtell rates to investigate its own founder is buying distance from its own law firm. The one-sentence statement with no stated scope is the tell -- nothing has been conceded, including what is being looked into.

WATCH NEXT

Q3 FY2027 earnings next Tuesday, 17 November, 2 p.m. Pacific.

Taipei closes up 3.6% as TSMC jumps almost 5%, and the AP wire circulates in two versions

WHAT HAPPENED

The Taiex **closed up 3.62%** on Wednesday, TSMC up almost 5% on its dividend and its October sales (Focus Taiwan). Treat the rest of the region carefully. The AP Asia wrap went out in at least two renderings, neither stating a time zone: an earlier has the Taiex at +2.1% and the Nikkei at 60,942.48, a later one +3.6% and 61,248.59. Only Taipei is confirmed as a close; Seoul, Shanghai and Hong Kong had not shut when either file was written, so every Kospi, Shanghai and Hang Seng figure circulating this morning is intraday. One more wire error: the same wrap says TSMC's October revenue was "nearly six times higher than a year earlier". Its own 6-K says +59.7%.

WHAT IT MEANS

Asia decoupled from New York for a second session, and the Taiwan leg of it is simply TSMC. The lesson is procedural: two timestamps on one wire are two snapshots, not two sources.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the regional rally survives Nvidia's results on 17 November.

BUSINESS

A hot inflation print that cannot say how hot, year on year

WHAT HAPPENED

The October CPI landed on schedule Tuesday at 8.30 a.m. Eastern. All items rose **0.4% on the month**, seasonally adjusted, after 0.6% in September; core -- all items less food and energy -- rose **0.3%**, as in each of the two months before. Energy added 0.7%, food 0.5%, shelter 0.3%. What is missing is the number everyone quotes: BLS "did not collect survey data for October 2025 because of a lapse in appropriations", so for most series it **cannot publish a 12-month change at all**, and the tables print a dash where the headline rate goes. A few components survive: gasoline **+37.4%**, new vehicles +0.7%, used cars and trucks -3.3%, unadjusted.

WHAT IT MEANS

Anyone citing a US annual inflation rate for October is citing an estimate, not a measurement. What is left is the monthly run-rate, and 0.4% a month does not annualise anywhere near target.

WATCH NEXT

The next CPI is 10 December -- the day after the Fed decides.

Waller set a tripwire hours before the print, and the print hit it

WHAT HAPPENED

Governor Christopher Waller told the Bank of England Watchers' Conference in London on Tuesday morning that if "the October CPI inflation data out later today are similar to the past two monthly readings" -- core around 0.3% "or even higher" -- then "I believe a 50 basis point hike in the policy rate should be considered at the December meeting" (speech text). He added: "Hiking only 25 basis points would put our credibility at risk, a risk I am not eager to take." Core printed 0.3% hours later. The range is **3.75% to 4.00%** after the 28 October hold, decided **10-2**, Cook and Hammack both dissenting for a quarter-point rise.

WHAT IT MEANS

A governor naming his condition in public and the condition being met the same afternoon is about as explicit as this Fed gets without a decision. Two members already wanted a hike before this print. A half-point move is now a live possibility, not a thought experiment. One thing we are not printing: a circulating set of Lorie Logan quotes dated to Tuesday belongs to an October speech and a 2024 conference.

WATCH NEXT

FOMC on 8-9 December, with new projections.

Stocks give back part of Monday's rally; the 10-year goes to 4.98%

WHAT HAPPENED

Tuesday's closes: S&P 500 **7,520.93, -0.4%**; Nasdaq **25,065.87, -0.7%**; Dow **52,231.89, -0.3%**; Russell 2000 **2,821.38, -0.7%** (AP closing table). Nvidia did much of that work. The Treasury's own daily par curve puts the **10-year at 4.98%, from 4.88%** Monday, the 30-year at 5.35% (Treasury). Brent's January contract settled at **$91.49**, down $1.08; WTI's December at **$86.04**, down 81 cents.

WHAT IT MEANS

A rates move, not a growth move. Equities handed back roughly a third of Monday's 2.35% gain while the long end repriced. Brent has fallen from $115 at the start of the month, so the Gulf risk premium is draining even as the shipping attacks continue.

WATCH NEXT

Whether the 30-year holds above 5.3%.

STARTUPS

Europe took almost all of the mid-market this cycle. Nothing datable came back from India, the Gulf, Latin America or Africa inside the window.

Mercor announces $750m at a reported $20bn

WHAT HAPPENED

Mercor, which sells AI training data and agent evaluation to enterprises, **announced a $750m Series D at a $20bn valuation** (SiliconAngle). Announced rather than confirmed closed; we have not verified a lead investor or how it splits between primary and secondary. Several outlets carry it, so it is not single-sourced, but every specific is headline-level.

WHAT IT MEANS

Evaluation is becoming its own layer of the stack. If models converge on capability, the buyer's problem shifts to proving which one is better at their particular job -- and that is a service you can charge for.

WATCH NEXT

The company's own release, for the lead and the structure.

Alta raises $47.5m to put a compliance layer under stablecoin settlement

WHAT HAPPENED

Alta -- formerly Metal, building its own layer-1 chain with bank-facing compliance built in -- announced a **$47.5m Series A** on Tuesday led by **Index Ventures**, with GV, Blackbird, Square Peg and Capital49, the fund set up by Airwallex's co-founders (Fortune; the headline says $48m, the body $47.5m). No valuation disclosed. Twenty-five staff, San Francisco and Melbourne. Chief executive Loong Wang: "We often say we wouldn't have built an L-1 if we didn't have to."

WHAT IT MEANS

The interesting detail is who is paying. A payments company's founders funding the chain their own industry would have to settle on is a bet that the compliance layer, not the chain, is the scarce asset.

WATCH NEXT

Whether a named bank goes live on it.

Tuesday's round sheet: nuclear waste, German RNA, and AI bookkeeping twice over

WHAT HAPPENED

From Tuesday's funding sheet, all announced rather than closed and most single-sourced: **Project Omega**, $80m Series A led by B Capital, recovering usable material from spent nuclear fuel by pyroprocessing, in Newport, Rhode Island. **SRTD Biotech**, a EUR 31.5m seed led by Mérieux Equity Partners with NRW.BANK and the Boehringer Ingelheim Venture Fund, in Jülich. **Sumary**, $25m seed led by Singular, Copenhagen, automating month-end close. **Coframe**, $25m Series A co-led by Khosla and Hanabi. And **Spines**, Tel Aviv, $29m of equity plus a separate $35m non-dilutive facility -- note the structure, not $64m of equity.

WHAT IT MEANS

Two of the five sell the same thing: software doing the work a junior accountant used to. The nuclear-waste round is the outlier worth watching, because pyroprocessing has a long history of being technically possible and commercially nowhere.

WATCH NEXT

Whether any of the European rounds files confirming paperwork this month.

US

Jordan takes the House Republican leadership; Thune keeps the Senate's by voice vote

WHAT HAPPENED

House Republicans, by secret ballot behind closed doors Tuesday, chose **Jim Jordan** over **Steve Scalise** to lead them in the minority from 3 January -- **106 to 73**, according to members in the room, since the conference publishes no tally (Roll Call). Tom Emmer held off August Pfluger for whip, no margin reported anywhere; Lisa McClain kept the conference chair against two challengers; Mike Johnson did not stand. In the Senate, John Thune and his slate came back **by voice vote**, so there are no counts at all: Barrasso whip, Tom Cotton conference chair, Capito at policy, Bernie Moreno newly picked for the NRSC (Roll Call). Five senators led by Ron Johnson pushed the start back a few hours and changed nothing.

WHAT IT MEANS

The House picked its most confrontational available option for opposition; the Senate picked continuity after losing seven seats, and did it on a voice vote so nobody has to own it. Neither conference has yet held anyone responsible for 3 November.

WATCH NEXT

Ranking-member assignments, and the 11 December funding deadline.

Hegseth's impeachment articles go to committee, 211-204

WHAT HAPPENED

The House disposed of Thomas Massie's eight articles of impeachment against Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth on Tuesday by **referring them to the Judiciary Committee, 211 to 204** -- Roll Call 317, H.Res. 1655 (Stars and Stripes). That is a referral, not a motion to table, though several outlets called it a tabling; the effect is the same, which is that nobody voted on the merits. Massie was the only Republican to oppose it. Al Jazeera, alone, counts eighteen members not voting, eleven of them Democrats -- with full attendance it would have failed. Hegseth: "I stand behind every one of these operations. I was proud to execute them, and I would do it again tomorrow." No source says Speaker Johnson ruled the resolution privileged, so we do not write that he did.

WHAT IT MEANS

Worth correcting one thing both the president and the secretary said: they called Massie a defeated former congressman. He is neither. He lost the Kentucky Republican primary on 19 May, 54.9% to 45.1%, and holds his seat until 3 January. A politician's insult is still a factual claim.

WATCH NEXT

Whether Judiciary does anything at all.

Still no official Senate result in Mississippi; Alaska counts to 18 November

WHAT HAPPENED

Eight days on, the Mississippi Secretary of State's results page still lists only the 10 March primaries. There is no November general result of any kind, and Scott Colom's roughly **2,574-vote** lead over Cindy Hyde-Smith exists on media tallies alone. In Alaska, 24,000-odd votes were added Tuesday: **Mary Peltola leads Dan Sullivan 49% to 47.2%** in the Senate race, Nick Begich leads the at-large House seat 48.9% to 41%, and Jonathan Kreiss-Tomkins has 49.9% of first choices for governor -- above 50% he skips the ranked-choice round entirely. Ballot Measure 2, repealing ranked-choice voting, is behind, **No 53 to Yes 47** (Alaska Public Media, our only source for these).

WHAT IT MEANS

Alaska is slow by design and will resolve. Mississippi is slow without a published process, which is a different problem: a two-thousand-vote Senate race with no official number anywhere is an invitation to litigate whatever number eventually appears.

WATCH NEXT

More Alaska results Friday, ranked-choice tabulation 18 November.

WORLD POLITICS

A second day in Abu Dhabi, a prisoner exchange proposed rather than agreed, and 163 drones overnight

WHAT HAPPENED

Ukrainian, Russian and American negotiators met in Abu Dhabi on Tuesday and reconvened Wednesday. Ukrinform, attributing Volodymyr Zelensky, says the **possibility** of a large exchange was discussed; the Kyiv Post has the two sides weighing up to **1,500 prisoners each** (Kyiv Post). Two Ukrainian outlets reported it as agreed, one hedging to "reportedly", and nothing else supports that. Moscow raised territorial claims; Ukraine rejected a US plan to redraw Donbas borders. Overnight, Russia launched **163 strike drones and one Kh-59/69 missile**, 91 of the drones jet-powered Shahed variants; the Ukrainian Air Force's account of an attack on itself puts **130 drones and 14 Banderol units** stopped and 17 locations hit (its own 8 a.m. count). Odesa region lost power to 135,000 consumers and a woman of 70 died of her injuries. Moldova said two Banderol munitions crossed its airspace at 6.04 and 6.06 a.m.

WHAT IT MEANS

Talks on prisoners and guarantees while the southern grid takes its heaviest night of the week. Nothing in the readouts touches a ceasefire. Moldova on the flight path twice in three minutes is the new fact. The G7 ministers in Paris, separately, finished Tuesday with a 12-page Ukraine statement reportedly adopted but unreleased -- and an unpublished statement cannot be quoted.

WATCH NEXT

The coalition-of-the-willing meeting in Germany on 19 November.

Another tanker struck off Oman, and an ADNOC ship damaged inside UAE waters

WHAT HAPPENED

Two fresh incidents Tuesday. A vessel operated by **ADNOC Logistics & Services** was damaged in an attack **inside UAE territorial waters**; and UKMTO's **Warning 201-26** reported a tanker struck by an unidentified projectile **19 nautical miles north-east of Lima, Oman, at 13.38 UTC**, the master reporting all crew safe (gCaptain). No names, flags, owners or cargoes disclosed for either, nobody named as responsible, and it is not known whether the two are linked. The industry tally: Hormuz stays at **severe**, 177 security incidents since 1 March, daily transits down to single or low double digits against about 138 a day in 2025.

WHAT IT MEANS

A ship hit inside Emirati waters is a different order of thing from one hit in the strait, and the UAE is the party least able to shrug it off. The transit count is the real measure: whoever is doing this has cut traffic through Hormuz by something like ninety per cent without ever closing it.

WATCH NEXT

Whether any flag state or owner is named.

Israel: a Speaker nominated, a vote set for next Tuesday, coalition talks cancelled

WHAT HAPPENED

The Knesset still has not voted on a Speaker. **Matan Kahana** of Yashar is the Eisenkot bloc's agreed nominee -- note the first name, which we had wrong yesterday -- and **67 MKs** have signed a demand to replace the incumbent, Amir Ohana, with Ynet putting the vote **next Tuesday** (Ynet; Times of Israel). Separately **Yashar** -- the party, not Gadi Eisenkot personally, as some accounts had it -- cancelled scheduled coalition talks with Likud over what it called Netanyahu's divisive speech in the chamber.

WHAT IT MEANS

Eisenkot can assemble 67 votes on a procedural question and still not form a government, which is the difficulty in one line: the anti-Netanyahu majority agrees on who holds the chair and not on who holds the cabinet.

WATCH NEXT

The Speaker vote next Tuesday, and whether the Likud talks resume.

SOURCES

Bureau of Labor Statistics - Consumer Price Index, October 2026

Federal Reserve - speech by Governor Waller, 10 November

Federal Reserve - FOMC statement, 28 October 2026

Federal Reserve - FOMC calendar

US Treasury - daily par yield curve, November 2026

AP closing table via La Nacion - Tuesday 10 November

Crude futures settlements, 10 November (Xinhua via The Star)

Nvidia - statement from the independent members of the board

Malay Mail - The Information's $7.5bn claim, and Reuters' caveat

The Next Web - Nvidia's board, Joon Kim and the Cooley connection

Investing.com - Senator Cramer calls for Huang's resignation

Focus Taiwan - Taiex ends sharply higher as TSMC soars almost 5%

TSMC - October 2026 revenue, Form 6-K

MarketScreener - TSMC board approves up to $500m each in Anthropic and OpenAI

Anthropic - Amendment No. 2 to Form S-1 (filing reproduction)

Elysee - Paris Call for AI Safety and Security

Fortune - Alta's Series A

SiliconAngle - Mercor's $750m Series D

Tech Startups - funding round-up, 10 November

Roll Call - a new minority leader for House Republicans

Roll Call - Thune will lead Republicans through the minority

Stars and Stripes - House sends Hegseth impeachment resolution to committee

Clerk of the House - Roll Call 317

Ballotpedia - Kentucky's 4th congressional district, 2026

Mississippi Secretary of State - election results

Alaska Public Media - Peltola and Kreiss-Tomkins strengthen leads

Kyiv Post - Ukraine and Russia weigh exchange of up to 1,500 prisoners each

Kyiv Post - the overnight attack, 11 November

Ukrinform - Zelensky on the Abu Dhabi talks

gCaptain - ADNOC vessel damaged, UKMTO Warning 201-26

Ynet - 67 MKs move to replace Speaker Ohana

Times of Israel - Eisenkot bloc agrees on Matan Kahana for Speaker

The Decoder - the Paris declaration on AI safety